Whoever it was didn't recognize me in Marko's hat. So I was able to stroll casually down to Billy and lean into his police car and whisper: *Bogey at three o'clock.*

What? No!

Billy, how could they have known?

Search me.

No one knows I'm here. Are they tracking me? Are they getting into my phone? Or Flack's?

Billy bolted from the car, ran around the corner, surprised the two paps. He screamed at them. But they screamed right back. Entitled. Emboldened.

They didn't get their photo that night—small victory. But very soon after they papped me and Flack, and those photos set off a frenzy. Within hours a mob was camped outside Flack's parents' house, and all her friends' houses, and her grandmother's house. She was described in one paper as my "bit of rough," because she'd once worked in a factory or something.

Jesus, I thought, are we really such a country of insufferable snobs?

I continued to see Flack on and off, but we didn't feel free anymore. We kept on, I think, because we genuinely enjoyed each other's company, and because we didn't want to admit defeat at the hands of these arseholes. But the relationship was tainted, irredeemably, and in time we agreed that it just wasn't worth the grief and harassment.

Especially for her family.

Goodbye, we said. Goodbye and good luck.

25.

I WENT WITH JLP to Kensington Palace for a cocktail with General Dannatt.

As we knocked at the door to the general's apartment I felt jumpier than I had when leaving for war.